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b. Special Commodity Warehouses

These warehouses are specially constructed for storing specific type of commodities like tobacco, cotton, wool etc. These warehouses reduce loss of quality and quantity to a great extent. Storage of petrol and oil requires special type of vertical, cylindrical storage tanks.

c. Cold Storages or Refrigerated Warehouses

Goods are transported in refrigerated containers and stored in refrigerated warehouses. These warehouses are used for storing perishable goods like fruits, vegetables, eggs, butter, fish, meat, etc. Goods stored in cold storages without deterioration in quality, can be made available throughout the year.

d. Climate Controlled Warehouses

The controlled climate environment can reduce the rate of metabolism in fruits and vegetables. Humidity controlled environments for delicate products such as flowers in dirt-free facilities in these warehouses.

e. Automated Warehouses

Automated facilities which can handle several hundreds of kilograms of product at a time. Inside the warehouse premises physical distribution activities are carried out by moving product filled pallets (i.e. platforms that hold large amounts of product). It requires huge investment, latest technology and large turnover of goods.

13.04 Functions of Warehouses

Warehouses render invaluable services to the society by performing the following functions:

(i) Storage

There is a time gap between the time of production and the time of consumption and a gap between demand and supply. The surplus goods are stored properly for the purpose of supplying them at right place and the right time.

(ii) Price Stabilization

Warehousing ensures price stabilization by supplying goods as and when demanded. It acts as a cushion to absorb price fluctuations and supplies the goods at more or less uniform prices throughout the year.

(iii) Equalization of Demand and Supply

Warehousing equalizes the demand and supply of goods by storing thee goods when they are not demanded and releasing them



Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority(WRDA)

To develop and regulate the warehousing industry in India, Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority was established under the Warehousing (Development and Regulation) Act, 2007. Its objective is to improve the storage capacity in the country and also help producers, farmers and consumers get a better deal by cutting the intermediaries and wastages.